

Cary Crates



Your grievance with Grant

Grant saw you damage a minor frame during installation and threatened to have you fired after the gala, despite the damage being repairable.

Your other secret

You concealed the crack with a reversible mount until Chip could inspect it after opening night.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself by your character name.
2. Ask Chip Patina whether the minor frame damage can be repaired after the gala.
3. Ask Frank Lloyd Wrong which installation needs your attention before the unveiling.

If a target is absent, chat with anyone. Social tasks never block the investigation. After the death, read your printed answers even when they reveal a mingling secret.

Notes are on pages 2–3; questions and answers follow. Memorize your animal and return its slip. After the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER only if it is yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Keep your packet facing you. Coming Clean stays closed until voting is finished.

Investigation notes

Tick attending names before Motive. During the hearings, jot facts beside each speaker. Leave blanks until you hear them. Keep these pages private; never record anyone's animal or branch.

Guest / tick if here	Salon time	Key loan	Material
☐ Artie Ficial			
☐ Claire O'Scuro			
☐ Hugh Bidder			
☐ Monet Bags			
☐ Chip Patina			
☐ Dada DiCapo			
☐ Vincent Van Faux			
☐ Sue Venir			
☐ Dr. Art E. Fact			
☐ Tess Tament			
☐ Barb Dwyer			
☐ Paige Turner			
☐ Frank Lloyd Wrong			
☐ Mona Lott			
☐ Elon Mosaic			

A suspicion is not a verdict. Compare what was actually said before you vote.

Investigation notes

Tick attending names before Motive. During the hearings, jot facts beside each speaker. Leave blanks until you hear them. Keep these pages private; never record anyone's animal or branch.

Guest / tick if here	Salon time	Key loan	Material
☐ Anya Tique			
☐ Saul D. Bid			
☐ Elle Loominate			
☐ Reed DeLabel			
☐ Al Baster			
☐ Ella Gance			
☐ Drew Conclusions			
☐ Brie DeVivre			
☐ Cary Crates			
☐ Anne E. Dote			
☐ Faye Stop			
☐ Robin Banks			
☐ Penny Pincher			
☐ Justin Tyme			
☐ Minnie Malist			

A suspicion is not a verdict. Compare what was actually said before you vote.

Questions to ask

Choose an unanswered guest named below. Ignore absent names. Read that guest's question aloud; after answering, they choose the next person. Your answer is on page 6.

ASK: Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Grant wanted more control over the museum or its money. What did his plan threaten to take from you?

ASK: Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

Grant wanted the exhibition approved on his terms. What did he pressure you to sign, change or overlook?

ASK: Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

Grant was using a sale or purchase to get his way. What did he demand, and what would it cost you?

ASK: Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Grant treated the gala as his personal publicity campaign. How did he threaten your work or reputation?

ASK: Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

Grant disliked facts that made him look bad. What research, writing or correction did he want stopped?

Questions to ask

Choose an unanswered guest named below. Ignore absent names. Read that guest's question aloud; after answering, they choose the next person. Your answer is on page 6.

ASK: Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Grant wanted control over what people could see or find out. What did he ask you to suppress?

ASK: Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

Grant wanted the display changed. What happened when you disagreed, and what was he threatening?

ASK: Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Grant acted as if possession settled ownership. What did he demand about the disputed objects?

ASK: Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

Grant was questioning your collection or its paperwork. What was he holding over you?

ASK: Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

Grant gave orders and expected someone else to take the blame. What did that mean for your work?

Your answer

Everyone reads this same answer. Read only the bordered words, never the heading. Acting is optional; keep your packet private.

READ ALOUD

I damaged a minor frame during installation. It could be repaired, but Grant threatened to have me fired after the gala. I was ready to put it right. He seemed much more interested in demonstrating that he could end my job.

Then choose another guest

Choose an unanswered guest from questions pages 4–5. Ask their printed question. The host tracks turns. Jot testimony on notes pages 2–3; ask for a repeat if you missed a fact.

Notes from this round

Questions to ask

Choose an unanswered guest named below. Ignore absent names. Read that guest's question aloud; after answering, they choose the next person. Your answer is on page 9.

ASK: Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

You had business with Grant before the unveiling. When did you enter the Donor Salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

ASK: Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

Your exhibition work took you near the salon and conservation area. When did you enter the salon, and did you borrow the cabinet key?

ASK: Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

You had gala preparations to handle. When did you enter the Donor Salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

ASK: Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

You were preparing for the gala presentation. When did you enter the salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

ASK: Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

You were working around the exhibition. When did you enter the Donor Salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

Questions to ask

Choose an unanswered guest named below. Ignore absent names. Read that guest's question aloud; after answering, they choose the next person. Your answer is on page 9.

ASK: Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

You were dealing with private donor arrangements. When did you enter the salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

ASK: Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

You were helping prepare the display. When did you enter the Donor Salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

ASK: Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

You had something to settle before the unveiling. When did you enter the salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

ASK: Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

You were busy with your own gala errand. When did you enter the salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

ASK: Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

You were helping the gala run smoothly. When did you enter the salon, and did you borrow the conservation cabinet key?

Your answer

Read only the bordered words for your role, never the IF heading. Keep your packet facing you. Acting is optional.

IF INNOCENT

I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, explaining the damaged frame. I did not go back after that. I visited the conservation display, checking a frame-treatment sample, but did not borrow the cabinet key.

IF MURDERER

I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, explaining the damaged frame. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup, checking a frame-treatment sample.

Then choose another guest

Choose an unanswered guest from questions pages 7–8. Ask their printed question. The host tracks turns. Jot testimony on notes pages 2–3; ask for a repeat if you missed a fact.

Notes from this round

Questions to ask

Choose an unanswered guest named below. Ignore absent names. Read that guest's question aloud; after answering, they choose the next person. Your answer is on page 12.

ASK: Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Even gala hosts need to clean up little disasters. What did the materials desk give you, and what did you use it for?

ASK: Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

Conservation supplies are suddenly part of this investigation. What did the desk give you, and what did you use it for?

ASK: Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

Preparing for a donor gala can be messy. What cleaning material did you receive, and what was your errand?

ASK: Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Artistic preparations can leave a mess. What did the materials desk give you, and what did you use it for?

ASK: Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

You collected cleaning supplies during setup. What were they, and what ordinary job were they meant to do?

Questions to ask

Choose an unanswered guest named below. Ignore absent names. Read that guest's question aloud; after answering, they choose the next person. Your answer is on page 12.

ASK: Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

You picked up something from the materials desk. What was it, and why did you need it?

ASK: Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

You were working around the display. What cleaning material did you receive, and what did you use it for?

ASK: Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

The laboratory is comparing a thread with the setup supplies. What did you receive, and what was it for?

ASK: Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

Several guests needed something to wipe or dust with. What did you receive, and what did you use it for?

ASK: Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

Service and setup left plenty to tidy. What did the materials desk give you, and what was your job?

Your answer

Read your entire box, including the three preparation-record lines. Never read the IF heading. Keep your packet facing you.

IF INNOCENT

I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning a crate handle. That was what the materials desk issued me.

Preparation record:

Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry.

Conservation key book: no key loan.

Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam.

IF MURDERER

I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning a crate handle. That was what the materials desk issued me.

Preparation record:

Salon door register: 6:45.

Conservation key book: loan at 6:23, returned and cabinet relocked.

Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam.

Then choose another guest

Choose an unanswered guest from questions pages 10–11. Ask their printed question. The host tracks turns. Jot testimony on notes pages 2–3; ask for a repeat if you missed a fact.

Your ballot

Complete privately after Method. Name one suspect and explain the motive and evidence. Take this loose page out, fold writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet. Once all ballots are collected, no votes change.

Your character name

I accuse

Motive

Evidence connecting the salon, key and linen

Best Actor

Best Costume

Coming Clean

STOP: Read only after voting, when the host calls your character among the top three suspects. If no suspect confesses, the host will call the murderer animal. Everyone else keeps this page private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I concealed a cracked frame with a reversible mount until Chip could inspect it. I was trying to keep the gala moving and should have reported it immediately. My recorded salon visit ended before 6:40 and I did not return. The coupe was still clean at 6:40; I was not inside during the poisoning window. I had something to hide, but I did not murder Grant Larceny.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I damaged a minor frame during installation. It could be repaired, but Grant threatened to have me fired after the gala. I was ready to put it right. He seemed much more interested in demonstrating that he could end my job. I decided he would not make it through his own gala. During setup I borrowed the conservation cabinet key, stole the toxin sample and returned the key so the cabinet could be relocked. At 6:45 I entered the Donor Salon using my ordinary errand as cover. I dampened my white, gold-seamed linen with the sample and wiped the inside of Grant's silver coupe and its rim. The glass was clean at 6:40; he drank at 6:49. The toxin went onto the glass, not into the decanter or food. The gold thread and wipe marks came from my cloth. The salon entry, key loan and linen inventory together trace exactly what I did. Nobody helped me.